생활 속 소리 말: 무슨 소리가 나요?

Learners read common Korean sound words (onomatopoeia) in notices, messages, and daily talk and work out what is happening.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

By the end, you can read 10 everyday Korean sound words in short notices and messages and say what sound they show and what is happening.

1 EVERYDAY SOUND WORDS

1	**쿵쿵** (kungkung — thump thump)	Heavy steps or hits that happen again and again. 예: 누가 계단을 쿵쿵 내려와요.
2	**쾅** (kwang — bang, slam)	One loud, strong hit, like a door slamming. 예: 바람 때문에 문이 쾅 닫혔어요.
3	**똑똑** (ttokttok — knock knock)	Knocking on a door. It can also mean water dripping. 예: 똑똑, 들어가도 돼요?
4	**딩동** (dingdong — doorbell)	The sound of a doorbell or a buzzer. 예: 딩동! 택배 왔습니다.
5	**보글보글** (bogeulbogeul — bubbling)	Soup or water bubbling as it boils. 예: 찌개가 보글보글 끓으면 두부를 넣으세요.
6	**지글지글** (jigeuljigeul — sizzling)	Meat or oil sizzling in a hot pan. 예: 삼겹살이 지글지글 익고 있어요.
7	**콜록콜록** (kollokkollok — cough cough)	The sound of coughing. 예: 아이가 밤새 콜록콜록 기침을 했어요.
8	**쨍그랑** (jjaenggeurang — crash (glass))	Glass or a plate breaking. 예: 쨍그랑! 유리컵이 깨졌어요.
9	**꼬르륵** (kkoreureuk — stomach growl)	Your stomach making noise when you are hungry. 예: 꼬르륵... 우리 밥부터 먹을까요?
10	**윙윙** (wingwing — buzz, hum)	A buzzing insect or a running machine, like a fan. 예: 선풍기가 윙윙 돌아가요.

2 HOW TO READ SOUND WORDS

One sound vs. many: a single word like 쾅 usually means it happened once. A doubled word like 쿵쿵 or 콜록콜록 means it happened again and again.

Sound words often come right before the verb (문이 쾅 닫혔어요), before 소리가 나다 (꼬르륵 소리가 났어요), or with -거리다 to make a verb (윙윙거리다 = to keep buzzing).

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3 DIFFERENT FROM ENGLISH

Korean adults use sound words a lot. You will see them in news, food ads, webtoons, apartment notices, and texts with friends. Don't think of them as baby talk.

Some sounds are close to English (딩동 = ding-dong), but many are not (똑똑 = knock knock, 콜록콜록 = cough cough). Learn each one as a word, and don't try to guess it from English.

You will see these sound words in everyday talk, text messages, food ads, and apartment notices.

4 YOUR TURN

READ AND FIND THE SOUND

Read each Korean sentence or text, then choose, write, or explain the sound word.

1. Read the apartment notice and answer in English. Which two noises are the problem, and after what time should people be careful?:
「밤늦게 아이들이 뛰는 쿵쿵 소리와 문을 쾅 닫는 소리 때문에 아래층 주민이 힘들어합니다. 밤 10시 이후에는 조심해 주세요.」

2. Choose the right sound word:
①라면 물이 (보글보글 / 지글지글) 끓어요.
②프라이팬에서 계란이 (보글보글 / 지글지글) 익어요.

3. Write the sound word from this sheet that you hear in each situation:
①누가 현관 벨을 눌렀어요.
②접시를 바닥에 떨어뜨려서 깨졌어요.
③감기에 걸린 친구가 기침을 해요.

4. Fill in the blank with one sound word from this sheet:
①아침을 굶었더니 수업 중에 배에서 ____ 소리가 났어요.
②여름밤에 모기가 귀 옆에서 ____거려서 잠이 깼어요.

5. Read the messages and answer in English. What did Minsu do, and why didn't Jisu answer?: 민수: 아까 네 방 문을 똑똑 두드렸는데 대답이 없더라. / 지수:
미안, 이어폰을 끼고 있었어.

✓ ANSWERS

1) Children running (쿵쿵, heavy footsteps) and doors slamming (쾅); after 10 p.m.
2) ① 보글보글 ② 지글지글
3) ① 딩동 ② 쨍그랑 ③ 콜록콜록
4) ① 꼬르륵 ② 윙윙
5) He knocked on her door (똑똑). She was wearing earphones, so she didn't hear it.

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